

What is the easiest way to identify an agency, provider or initiative's indicators (KPIs and higher-level) and understand the level they are being struck at?

The best way to identify indicators for an agency, provider, organization or initiative is to do it against the relevant DoView strategy/outcomes diagram. This Putting Indicators Onto a DoView Strategy/Outcomes Diagram Tool (D5) shows how you can go through a DoView strategy/outcomes diagram, look at each box in it and ask the question: 'Is there a measure for this box?' This is, first, a much more efficient way of identifying indicators than just sitting down with a blank piece of paper and trying to think up relevant indicators.

Second, it provides a way of talking about what you want the organization or initiative to do (the box) separately from how you will measure it. This lets you identify and attempt to improve currently unmeasured steps and outcomes.

Third, it raises the question of whether or not a particular measure (indicator) is measuring exactly what is in the box that is visually positioned next to it.

Fourth, it lets you see how 'high up' the relevant DoView diagram an indicator is. This lets you identify if it is a higher or lower-level indicator.

Fifth, putting indicators onto a DoView strategy/outcomes diagram, you can also mark up which indicators are controllable by an organization or initiative and which are not-necessarily controllable. As discussed elsewhere, this is an important distinction. It determines whether or not the mere measurement of an indicator proves that it was the organization or initiative that made that indicator (and, by implication, the associated box) improve. This is also important when setting organization or initiative accountability if contracting under a controllables-only approach (see Four Types of Contracting for Outcomes or Outputs Tool (E4)).

As is discussed in the Developing or Reviewing an Outputs/Deliverables List Tool (D9) having both controllable (sometimes marked with an '@') and not-necessarily controllable indicators in the same DoView strategy/outcomes diagram makes for more coherent discussions about accountability, delegation, and contracting.